

Element C: Presentation and Justification of Solution Design Requirements

The development office at our independent boarding and day school has an overflow of items. The excess items piled on the floor hinder workflow and efficiency. Many items move around the development office; therefore, it is important to keep them organized. The current storage situation is unsatisfactory in the eyes of school donors and visitors.

Prioritized design requirements include:

1. **Accessible outlets** - Blocking outlets and windows can lead to overloaded circuits and maintenance issues, and blocking outlets will cause a fire hazard. (high)
2. **Concealed boxes** - Concealing exposed boxes helps maintain a tidy and professional environment, ensuring that unnecessary clutter is kept out of sight. This is especially important when donors visit, as it reassures them that their contributions are being used responsibly. A well-organized space reflects efficiency, professionalism, and care, reinforcing confidence in the organization's operations. (high)
3. **Comfortable and inviting to guests** - A well-organized and inviting space enhances workflow, minimizes distractions, and reassures donors, encouraging contributions. Maintaining a structured environment will strengthen the development office's mission and impact. (high)
4. **Storage space** - A large volume of items must be accommodated to ensure the organization and ease of access. (high)
5. **Beverage station** - A beverage station is a medium priority design requirement, serving as a welcoming touch for guests by providing coffee and other refreshments. It enhances hospitality and demonstrates courtesy, creating a comfortable and inviting atmosphere. (medium)

6. **Aesthetics** - The shelf must complement the current room style and maintain an elegant appearance to meet stakeholder expectations. Its design should align with the overall aesthetic while adding a polished and refined touch to the space. (medium)
7. **Lockable hallway storage** - A locked hallway storage space secures sensitive documents, prevents theft, and keeps materials organized for easy access in a school setting. (medium)
8. **Display** - Part of the cabinet should be designed for display, allowing for visible storage that enhances organization while maintaining a polished and professional look. This space could also be used to display art, antiques or other items of interest. (medium)

Through a collaborative process, we identified key requirements for optimizing space and functionality in the development office of our private boarding and day school. Initially, we conducted a brief interview with stakeholders Ms. P and Ms. C to gather their input, which led to our first draft of requirements. After refining and prioritizing the list, we held another meeting with them and shared the updated version for their feedback. Based on their insights, we made necessary adjustments and revised the designs accordingly.

The finalized requirements emphasize efficiency, organization, and aesthetics. High-priority storage solutions must accommodate a large volume of items while ensuring accessibility. Concealed boxes help maintain a professional, clutter-free environment, reassuring donors that their contributions are well-managed. A well-organized and inviting space supports workflow while minimizing distractions and encouraging donor engagement. Additionally, blocking outlets and windows poses fire hazards and maintenance issues, necessitating careful planning for accessibility and safety. A beverage station is a medium priority. The hospitality of

a beverage station is a welcoming atmosphere for guests. Aesthetic considerations are essential, with shelves needing to match the existing room style and maintain an elegant appearance per stakeholder expectations. Secure hallway storage safeguards sensitive documents, preventing unauthorized access. Furthermore, part of the cabinet should be displayable, balancing visibility with professionalism.

By implementing these carefully planned solutions, the development office can achieve a structured, secure, and visually appealing workspace that enhances productivity, ensures safety, and strengthens donor confidence in the organization's operations.